

KF Core Meeting Format #1¹

- *Designed for a meeting of no more than 4 KF members*
- *Lead Facilitator may email confirmation of reading assignments before the meeting*
- *Members rotate assignments each week*
- *Each reader reads BOTH the Intros and the Lessons for their assigned section*
- *Time stamps are optional*

MEMBER 1 (18min)

Opening
Presenting
Karis Circulation
Guidelines and Limitations
Mindfulness & Meditation

MEMBER 2 (25min)

Karis Confession
Toolbox
Sharing

MEMBER 3 (17min)

Bible Teaching
Integration
Ending Prayer / Announcements

MEMBER 4

Joins in sharing only.

KF MEETING SCHEDULE

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

We have a single purpose at Karis Fellowships: to support one another as we reorient to God and to our true glory. We are Christians who recognize our misorientation, that we have exchanged the truth for the lie of our Idol Self and pursued pride rather than love. We believe that only from our True Self, the self that God created, can we love authentically and become the people God

created us to be. We learn to respond to the gift of our real salvation in Jesus Christ by offering our true life to God as a gift, which is holy and acceptable to Him. Every week we come together to ground ourselves in reality, to help us put to death our false strivings and learn to apply real effort to our real growth as we pursue God's will and our true glory.

0:02 PRESENTING

We introduce ourselves to the group as we are at this moment. We respect the group by always announcing our presence.

My name is _____ . I am calling from _____ .

This is how things are for me today: _____ .

0:04 KARIS CIRCULATION

We practice mutual generosity with Karis Fellowships by returning gifts of service, skill, and finances. Through volunteering and a monthly gift of \$10 or more, we support and protect KF training for ourselves and for others. As we receive, we give. To participate, visit **Give a Gift** on the website.

0:05 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

We cooperate for the security and efficiency of the group.

We adhere to the time restraints.

We present ourselves authentically.

We offer our story and allow others to tell theirs.

We hold in sacred confidence what we learn about each other.

We withhold opinions on outside issues while in the meeting.

We commit to the authority of the Bible for our beliefs and choices.

We practice what we learn.

We share our finances, as we are able, to support the group.

We pray for each other.

0:06 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

We seek mindful living and true connection with God. Mindfulness teaches us gentle moment-by-moment awareness as we go about our lives. Meditation trains our mind, body, will, and heart for connection. With daily practice and patient endurance, we learn how to focus, to find stillness, to quiet the chatter and demands of our Idol Self. We practice the presence of God by dwelling, unguarded, in the present moment with the gift of our True Self.

(Pause while the lesson is read)

0:18 KARIS CONFESSION

We remind each other of the path that leads to our healing. In James 5:16-17 we read, "Therefore, confess your misorientation to one another, and pray for one another so that you may be healed. The energetic and active petition of an oriented person has much power." The Karis Confessions help us confess our sin and affirm our glory.

1. **We confess** that we have worshipped and served an Idol Self that we have created.
2. **We abandoned** the glory that was ours, designed for us by our Creator.
3. **We constructed** legal systems based on our own assessment of good and evil.
4. **We judged** ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.
5. **We attacked** and cruelly suppressed our True Self and lost our true life.
6. **We chose** to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.
7. **We commit** now to live in reality, choosing to believe rather than judge.
8. **We co-labor** with the Creator to seek and to save that which was lost.
9. **We learn** to withdraw from the Idol Self and begin investing in our True Self.
10. **We honor** our limitations and seek lives of gratitude.
11. **We take** responsibility for any damage that we have done.
12. **We circulate** our true resources, reconnecting to our Creator and to the Creation.

0:19 TOOLBOX

We offer tools that help us cooperate with God in the development of our True Self.

(Pause while the lesson is read)

0:28 SHARING

We give our True Self a voice by confessing our progress and discoveries. We learn to stop judging our expression which defuses the Idol's compelling need to perform. We also practice the gift of listening to another's voice without judgment or reaction. We listen with compassion and appreciation for the effort another has made toward orientation. Real sharing reminds us that we are not alone in our struggle toward an authentic life.

Please use your Meeting Preparation Guide to share your story for up to five minutes.

0:43 BIBLE TEACHING

We affirm the Bible as our one authority for our beliefs and choices. A mature guide can help us understand what the Bible teaches about our true nature and glory. We also learn the Scriptural basis for the tools offered in Karis Fellowships. With increasing vision, we develop our endurance, courage, and skills to live in the truth of who we were created to be.

(Pause while the lesson is read)

0:51 INTEGRATION

We integrate what we have learned into the rest of our person. The meeting starts us down a path to our healing, and sometimes we feel an emotional or physical response to what we have learned. We take this time to reorient ourselves on a physical and emotional level.

(Pause)

0:59 ENDING PRAYER

(Optional: Offer the prayer on KF Meeting document)

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together for healing and training. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week and reorient our lives to a more effective flow, to furthering our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

1:00 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ KF Core meetings designed and initiated by Rudd Olmstead, 2021.